

University of Pune Uses Open Source for Emailing 650,000 Students Regularly!

A look at the biggest technology deployments today reveals that open source technologies rule the roost. A check on the email system used by the University of Pune only strengthens this belief. Open source seems to be the way to go, particularly when it comes to communication. **Diksha P. Gupta** from *Open Source For You* explores the university's journey...



If you thought that the adoption of open source technology is growing because of the cost advantage it offers, you need to broaden your view and look at the complete picture. Open source technology is spreading its wings far and wide, and is being adopted for reasons beyond just cost benefits. Savitribai Phule Pune University presents one such example, where open source technology is being leveraged for different reasons.

Nitin Patil, IT manager - IT cell, Savitribai Phule Pune University, shares the story of the university's open source technology deployment with *Open Source For You* magazine. According to Patil, "The main focus of the university is higher education and creating knowledge wealth for society. Technology is a huge enabler in the process and, hence, it is extremely important to reach out to all students of the university and its affiliated colleges. Without good technology at its disposal, it would have been impossible to reach 650,000 students regularly." And this is exactly where open source technologies come to the rescue. We have seen it before and we will continue witnessing cases which prove that for a massive technology deployment like this, open source technology is a definite choice. To communicate with thousands of students and staff members associated with the university, Patil has deployed an email solution based on open source technology. After contemplating several other options, the IT head resorted to the one which was not only credible but allowed him complete freedom for the job.

The University selected Technoinfotech's Centralised Communication Platform solution to make the university's email communication system robust and smooth. Patil shares, "It was a strategic move to go to open source. Technoinfotech offered a scalable solution to establish an official communication platform for the university to correspond and communicate with its affiliated colleges, students and teachers through a centralised email and SMS facility. This was for various departments of the university."

When asked whether adopting open source technology was a challenge for him, Patil responds that he belongs to a university that is synonymous with innovation. He says, "Being an organisation in the education domain, the university is always ready to adopt newer technologies. There was, of course, no resistance to adopting open source technology at any point in time."

The open source email system is now being extensively used to communicate with the students and staff of the university. Patil asserts, "It is used extensively by all users, which is evident from the fact that mail traffic has increased from 5000 mails per month to 5000 mails per working day, on an average." Here's an indication of the kind of traffic that Technoinfotech's email system can handle—it has handled 7,500,000+ email transactions throughout the year; 1,900,000+ e-mails have been relayed through various university applications using APIs; 5,500,000+ email transactions have been done for corporate mailing; and 1,500,000+ DND transactional SMSs have been sent using APIs through various applications. And all this comes from an open source technology based email solution. Unicomm-@ is based on a true open source architecture, which offers maximum scalability and investment protection with no user based licensing for any component in the solution. It also comes with managed services with best-in-class monitoring.

Handling bulk emails is also not an issue for the university now, with Technoinfotech's email system in place. Unicomm-@ offers bulk email/SMS services through APIs using stringent DND and spam norms, and ensures industry standard delivery commitment, communication services, spam management, IP reputation building, user support, uptime, third party application support, etc.

The solution is implemented at the university data centre under the 'PUN' or Pune University Network. 